

Week 10 Interim: Urgency-Tier Messages, Prototype & Testing Plan

Context

Following a near-miss where an AI-triage alert was misread as lower urgency during a chaotic handover, this week's design goal is unambiguous, stress-testable urgency messaging, not sophistication. The four tiers below map directly onto the ESI groupings the Week 6-8 model already predicts, so no new model output is required, only how the existing prediction is communicated.

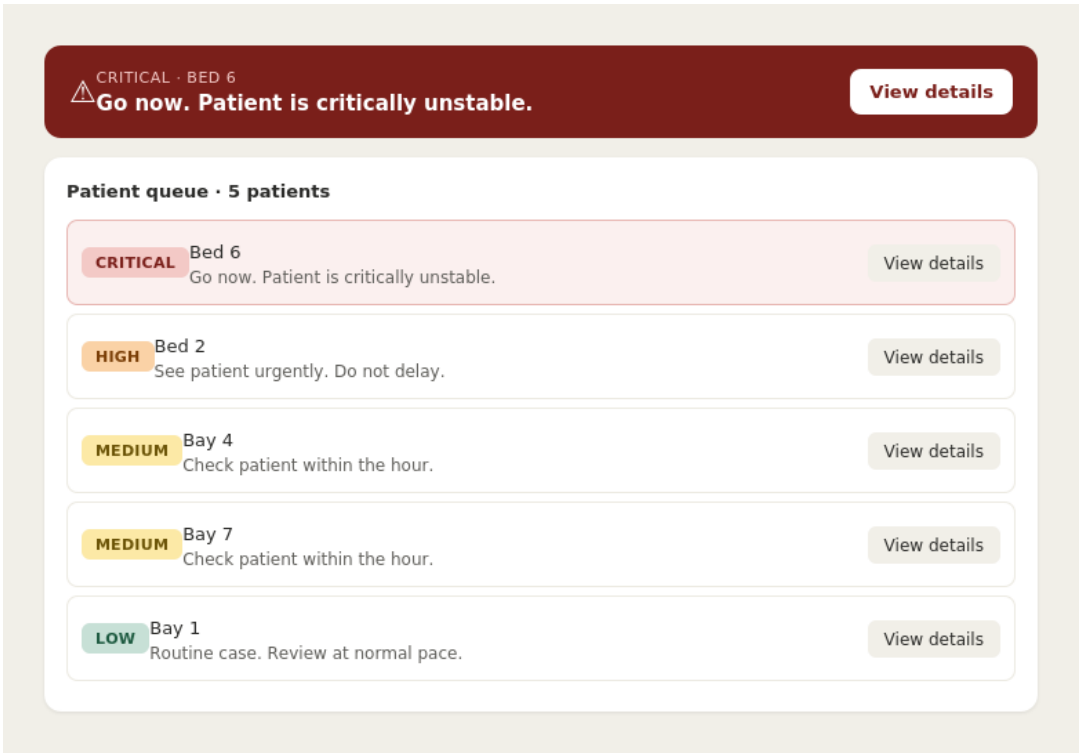
Task 1: Draft Urgency-Tier Messages (rough)

Each message is 12 words or fewer, active voice, includes one clear action verb, and color/tone escalates predictably from Low to Critical. These are draft wording for peer-testing this week, expected to change based on tester feedback before final submission.

Tier	Color	Message (draft)	Words	Maps to ESI (Wk 6-8 model)
Critical	Dark red	“Go now. Patient is critically unstable.”	6	ESI 1
High	Orange	“See patient urgently. Do not delay.”	6	ESI 2
Medium	Amber/yellow	“Check patient within the hour.”	5	ESI 3
Low	Green	“Routine case. Review at normal pace.”	6	ESI 4-5

Task 2: Initial Prototype Sketch

Low-fidelity GUI prototype showing the required elements: the patient queue with a per-patient urgency indicator, a persistent alert banner at the top for the Critical tier, and a consistent “View details” interaction on every row.



Draft prototype: top alert banner for the Critical case, plus the full patient queue with tier chips (color + text label) and a View details action per row.

Task 3: Plan for Peer Testing

Element	Plan
Testers	At least 3 cohort members, recruited from the CariSurg group - different people from those who reviewed the Week 9 mock-ups, to get a fresher read.
Method	Two-phase ranking exercise: (1) show the four messages as plain text only, no color, ask testers to rank them 1-4 by urgency from the words alone; (2) reveal the color-coded version and repeat the ranking. Compare the two rankings to see whether wording alone communicates urgency correctly, or whether color is doing all the work.

Data collection tool	A short structured interview (5-6 questions) rather than a full UEQ/SUS survey, since the sample size (3 testers) is too small for a standardized instrument to produce meaningful scores. Questions will ask: which message they misread, which they'd ignore under time pressure, and whether the escalation from Low to Critical felt predictable.
What will be recorded	Verbatim quotes for anything misread or misunderstood, the word-only vs. colored ranking for each tester, and any suggested rewording; documented directly, not summarized, so the final report can quote testers accurately.
Timing	Testing sessions planned for early in the second half of the week, leaving time to revise messages based on feedback before Tuesday's final submission.

Task 4: Accessibility Considerations (one-pager)

Concern	How the design addresses it
Colour-blindness	Every tier chip pairs color with a bold text label ("CRITICAL", "HIGH", etc.) - color is never the only signal, per WCAG guidance and the same principle used for the ESI palette in Week 9. Still to verify: run the actual hex values through a color-blindness simulator before final submission, rather than relying on visual judgement alone.
Cognitive load / end-of-shift fatigue	Messages are capped at 12 words, active voice, one action verb each, directly responding to the near-miss incident. The Critical tier additionally surfaces as a persistent top banner, not just a queue-row color, so it cannot be scrolled past or missed during a chaotic handover; this is the specific failure mode Dr. De Fretias flagged.
Noise level / auditory environment	Not yet addressed in this interim draft; the current prototype is visual-only. An audio cue for the Critical tier (distinct from ambient equipment alarms) is planned for the final prototype, informed by the HRI noise considerations already raised in Week 9.